

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86REYKJAO02091

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O 091517Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY REYKJAVIK
TO USIA WASHDC IMMEDIATE 2934
SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 9800
WHITE HOUSE WASHDC IMMEDIATE
INFO AMEMBASSY MOSCOW

UNCLAS REYKJAVIK 02091

FOR: USIA FOR DEPUTY DIRECTOR, EU; STATE FOR EUR, PA
(REDMAN); WHITE HOUSE AAFOR AMBASSADOR MATLOCK

E.O. 12356: N/A

SUBJECT: REF: REKJAVIK 02080 M

1. FOR THEIR SECOND PRESS CONFERENCE ON OCTOBER 9 AT THE SAGA HOTEL, THE SOVIETS ATTRACTED AN EVEN LARGER CROWD OF TV CREWS AND PRINT JOURNALISTS THAN FOR THEIR FIRST SESSION (REFTEL). THE THEME OF THE MEETING WAS REGIONAL CONFLICT; BRIEFERS WERE NIKOLAY SHISHLIN, CENTRAL COMMITTEE MEMBER, EVGENIY PRIMYAKOV, DIRECTOR OF IMEMO (INSTITUTE OF WORLD ECONOMY), AND ALEKSANDR BOVIN, POLITICAL COMMENTATOR WITH "IZVESTIYA." LESS POLISHED THAN THE FALIN/KOBYSH/ZHURKIN TROIKA, TODAY'S TRIO NEVERTHELESS HELD THE JOURNALISTS' ATTENTION FOR A FULL HOUR AND SALTED THEIR JARGON-LOADED REPLIES WITH OCCASIONAL JOKES.

2. THE SOVIETS PUBLICISTS MADE THE FOLLOWING POINTS:

-- -- THE SOVIET UNION IS COMMITTED TO FINDING
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POLITICAL SOLUTIONS TO REGIONAL CONFLICTS AND REJECTS MILITARY MEANS. AFGHANISTAN, NICARAGUA AND THE MIDDLE EAST DESERVE EQUAL ATTENTION AS THE MOST SERIOUS REGIONAL CONFLICTS FACING THE WORLD.

-- -- THE SOVIET UNION FULLY INTENDS TO FULFILL GORBACHEV'S VLADIVOSTOK PROMISE OF A PARTIAL WITHDRAWAL OF SOVIET TROOPS FROM AFGHANISTAN; WITHDRAWAL THIS YEAR IS STILL A POSSIBILITY. COMPLETE WITHDRAWAL DEPENDS.

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DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

REVIEWED by BA

DATE 11/14/89

() RELEASE () DECLASSIFY
() EXCISE () DECLASSIFY IN PART
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FOI, EO or PA exemption _____

TS authority to:

() CLASSIFY as _____, OADR
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INTER ALIA, ON GUARANTEES BY PAKISTAN AND IRAN OF NON-INTERFERENCE IN AFGHANISTAN AFFAIRS AND ON STABILIZATION OF "THE PEOPLE'S POWER" WITHIN AFGHANISTAN ITSELF.

-- -- THE MAJOR PURPOSE OF THE REYKJAVIK MEETING IS TO GET "A GREEN LIGHT" FOR A FULL SUMMIT. REYKJAVIK REPRESENTS "A MOMENT OF TRUTH" AND GORBACHEV WILL DO EVERYTHING IN HIS POWER TO BRING ABOUT A SUCCESSFUL MEETING. THE BRIEFERS TREATED ATTEMPTS TO Dampen EXPECTATIONS VIS-A-VIS THE REYKJAVIK TALKS AS PREMATURE.

3. QUESTIONS RE THEHVIET REACTION TO BERNARD KALB'S RESIGNATION AND CHARGES OF DISINFORMATION ON THE PART OF THE REAGAN ADMINISTRATION WITH RESPECT TO LIBYA, ON SOUTH AFRICA AND A ROLE FOR THE SOVIET UNION IN THE MIDDLE EAST ELICITED NO CLEAR RESPONSE FROM THE BRIEFERS. BOVIN, FOR EXAMPLE, CONSIDERED KALB'S RESIGNATION AS AN "HONORABLE" COURSE AND WENT ON TO SAY THAT ANY ALLEGED "DISINFORMATION ACTIVITY" ON THE PART OF THE AMERICAN GOVERNMENT WOULD NOT AFFECT THE REYKJAVIK TALKS. BOVIN ALSO REDUCED THE SOUTH AFRICAN ISSUE TO A CASE OF "ONE MAN, ONE VOTE." SHISHLIN UNDERSCORED THE IMPORTANCE THE SOVIET UNION ATTACHED TO UNCLASSIFIED UNCLASSIFIED:

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THE MIDDLE EAST, BUT EMPHASIZED THAT THE SOVIETS WOULD NOT ALLOW ANY GOVERNMENT TO DICTATE THE CONDITIONS OF ITS PARTICIPATION IN THE SEARCH FOR A SOLUTION.

4. DESPITE SOVIET ATTEMPTS TO CONFINE THE DISCUSSION TO REGIONAL ISSUES, THE MEDIA REPEATEDLY SHIFTED THE QUESTIONING TO HUMAN RIGHTS. SEVERAL JOURNALISTS BROUGHT UP THE SHERMAN CASE AND WERE INFORMED BY A DR. SAMUEL ZIVS, A MOSCOW LAW PROFESSOR HERE TO RESPOND TO QUESTIONS ABOUT JEWISH EMIGRATION, THAT THERE WERE NO LEGAL BARRIERS TO THE EMIGRATION OF SHERMAN'S SISTER FROM THE SOVIET UNION. (A NUMBER OF THE PRESS SEEMED CONVERSANT WITH THE ARRIVAL IN REYKJAVIK OF SOVIET EMIGRE SHERMAN, NEAR DEATH FROM LEUKEMIA, AND OF HIS PLANS TO PROTEST SOVIET FAILURE TO ALLOW HIS SISTER AND ONLY POTENTIAL BONE MARROW DONOR TO EMIGRATE. ACCORDING TO ZIVS, WHO INTERJECTED HIMSELF INTO THE FREE-FOR-ALL BETWEEN THE BRIEFERS AND JOURNALISTS, SHERMAN'S SISTER IS FREE TO LEAVE THE SOVIET UNION AT ANY TIME, ALTHOUGH HER HUSBAND STILL FACES LEGAL BARRIERS RELATING TO FAMILY MATTERS THAT MUST BE RESOLVED BEFORE HE CAN EMIGRATE.)

5. IN INDIVIDUAL INTERVIEWS WITH GROUPS OF JOURNALISTS FOLLOWING THE PRESS CONFERENCE, SHISHLIN CLEARED UP THE CONFUSION REGARDING MRS. GORBACHEV'S ARRIVAL AND

6. ANOTHER SESSION IS SCHEDULED FOR 11:00 OCTOBER 10 ON THE QUESTION OF "NEW REALITIES" WITHIN THE SOVIET UNION. THIS MEETING WILL FOCUS ON CHANGES WITHIN THE SOVIET SYSTEM. ZIVS INDICATED THAT HE WILL BE A PANEL MEMBER AND WILL DISCUSS THE PROBLEMS OF JEWS WITHIN SOVIET SOCIETY. IVORY

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